

Introduction to Psychology

PSYC 1301 – Section 401

Department of Psychology & Behavioral Science

Summer 2026

Instructor Information

Instructor: Dr. Marcus J. Holloway

Email: mjholloway@wcu.edu

Office Location: Whitmore Hall 214

Office Hours: MTW 10:00am – 12:00pm or by appointment

Preferred Method of Contact: mjholloway@wcu.edu or Campus LMS Inbox

When emailing, please include your course section number or class meeting time. My goal is to respond to all student communications within 24–48 hours on weekdays.

Teaching Assistant(s)

Brianna Okafor | Course TA | bokafor@wcu.edu

Devon Castillo | Course TA | dcastillo@wcu.edu

Course Details

Meeting Days/Times/Locations

Start Date	End Date	Location	Meeting Day	Start Time	End Time
05/27/2026	09/15/2026	WHMR 0105	MWF	01:00 PM	01:50 PM

Credit Hours: 3.00

Course Description

A survey of the scientific study of behavior and mental processes. Topics include biological bases of behavior, sensation and perception, learning and memory, motivation, emotion, personality, psychological disorders, and social psychology. Emphasis on applying psychological principles to everyday life.

Required Texts and Materials

Textbook: Psychology: Themes and Variations

ISBN: 9781337408202

Authors: Weiten, Wayne

Publisher: Cengage Learning

Edition: 10th

Additional Required Materials

- iClicker Cloud for in-class polling
- Access to library databases (ProQuest, PsycINFO)
- APA 7th Edition Style Guide (free PDF provided)

Course Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. CLO 1: Define and explain major psychological theories and their historical development
2. CLO 2: Identify the biological and environmental factors that influence human behavior
3. CLO 3: Analyze case studies using appropriate psychological frameworks
4. CLO 4: Evaluate research methodology including experimental design and ethical standards
5. CLO 5: Apply psychological concepts to personal and societal issues
6. CLO 6: Critically assess claims about human behavior presented in popular media

Grading Policies & Grading Scale

Grade Breakdown

Activity	Weight	Details
Attendance & Participation	10%	iClicker polls, attendance sign-in, in-class discussions
Quizzes	15%	10 weekly quizzes; lowest 2 dropped; open for 48 hrs after lecture
Written Reflection Papers	15%	3 papers, ~500 words each, due Weeks 3, 7, and 11
Midterm Exam 1	15%	Covers Weeks 1–4 material; June 24, 2026
Midterm Exam 2	15%	Covers Weeks 5–8 material; July 22, 2026
Midterm Exam 3	10%	Covers Weeks 9–11 material; August 19, 2026
Final Exam	20%	Comprehensive; September 12, 2026; 1:00 PM – 3:00 PM
Total	100%	

Grading Scale

A	A-	B+	B	B-	C+	C	C-	D+	D	D-	F
100–93	92–90	89–87	86–83	82–80	79–77	76–73	72–70	69–67	66–63	62–60	59–00

NOTE: Final grades are recorded as posted. No grade changes will be made after final grades are submitted.

Late Work Policy

- Late work is penalized 10% per day of delay.
- Assignments more than 5 days late will not be accepted.
- Lab/in-class work cannot be made up without a documented, university-approved excuse.

Important Exam Dates

Assessment	Date / Details
Midterm Exam 1	Covers Weeks 1–4 material; June 24, 2026
Midterm Exam 2	Covers Weeks 5–8 material; July 22, 2026
Midterm Exam 3	Covers Weeks 9–11 material; August 19, 2026
Final Exam	Comprehensive; September 12, 2026; 1:00 PM – 3:00 PM

Course Schedule

Note: This schedule is subject to change. Any modifications will be announced via the LMS and/or email.

Week / Dates	Topic(s)	Assignments / Notes
Week 1 (May 27–30)	History & Research Methods	Quiz 1 (opens Fri)
Week 2 (Jun 1–6)	Biological Bases of Behavior	Quiz 2; Syllabus Quiz due
Week 3 (Jun 8–13)	Sensation & Perception	Quiz 3; Reflection Paper 1 due Jun 13
Week 4 (Jun 15–20)	States of Consciousness	Quiz 4
Week 5 (Jun 22–27)	EXAM 1 – Jun 24 Learning	Quiz 5
Week 6 (Jun 29–Jul 4)	Memory	Quiz 6 (No class Jul 4)
Week 7 (Jul 6–11)	Cognition & Language	Quiz 7; Reflection Paper 2 due Jul 11
Week 8 (Jul 13–18)	Motivation & Emotion	Quiz 8
Week 9 (Jul 20–25)	EXAM 2 – Jul 22 Developmental Psych	Quiz 9
Week 10 (Jul 27–Aug 1)	Personality Theories	Quiz 10
Week 11 (Aug 3–8)	Psychological Disorders	Reflection Paper 3 due Aug 8
Week 12 (Aug 10–15)	EXAM 3 – Aug 19 Treatment of Disorders	—

Week / Dates	Topic(s)	Assignments / Notes
Week 13 (Aug 17–22)	Social Psychology	—
Week 14 (Aug 24–29)	Stress, Health & Coping	—
Week 15 (Aug 31–Sep 5)	Review & Special Topics	—
Final Exam	September 12, 2026 1:00 PM – 3:00 PM	Comprehensive – All Weeks

Course Policies

- Laptops and tablets are permitted for note-taking only; social media use will result in removal.
- Late work is penalized 10% per day; no work accepted more than 5 days past due date.
- Generative AI (ChatGPT, etc.) is NOT permitted for any assignment in this course.
- Academic integrity violations will be reported to the Office of Academic Affairs.
- Exams must be taken at the scheduled time; make-ups require documented emergencies submitted within 48 hours.
- Students requiring accommodations should provide documentation from the Disability Resource Center within the first two weeks.

Attendance Policy

Regular attendance is essential to success in this course. Students are expected to attend all scheduled class sessions and arrive on time. Attendance will be recorded each session.

Free Absences: Students are permitted two (2) free lecture absences and one (1) free lab absence per semester without penalty or documentation. Use these wisely.

Religious Observances: Notify the instructor in writing within the first two weeks of the semester. Arrangements for make-up work must be made in advance.

University Events: Provide official documentation from your university sponsor. Contact the instructor well in advance.

Exam Day Absences: Medical absences on exam days require documentation from a physician or the University Health Center and will be handled on a case-by-case basis.

Academic Integrity

Students are expected to maintain the highest standards of academic honesty. All submitted work must represent the student's own effort. Violations of the Academic Integrity Policy, including plagiarism, cheating, or unauthorized use of AI-generated content, will be referred to the Office of Academic Affairs and may result in a failing grade for the assignment or the course.

Generative AI Policy

The use of generative AI tools (including but not limited to ChatGPT, Google Gemini, Copilot, and DALL-E) is governed by the policy stated in the grading section above. Any violations will be treated as academic dishonesty. Students are encouraged to maintain time-stamped drafts and notes as evidence of independent work.

Disability Accommodations & Title IX

Disability Accommodations

Students who require academic accommodations must register with the Disability Resource Center (DRC) at drc.wcu.edu or by calling 828-227-2716. Once registered, students must submit an accommodation letter to the instructor at least one week before accommodations are needed. Accommodations are not retroactive.

Sexual Harassment & Title IX

All forms of sexual harassment, including sexual assault and dating violence, violate WCU policy and may violate federal law. Students may report concerns to the Title IX Coordinator at titleix@wcu.edu or 828-227-7021. Faculty are mandatory reporters.

Student Support Services

- Academic Success Center – Free tutoring and academic coaching: asc.wcu.edu
- Writing & Learning Commons – Writing support for all disciplines: writingcenter.wcu.edu
- Counseling & Psychological Services (CAPS) – Mental health support: 828-227-7469
- University Health Services – Medical and wellness support: 828-227-7640
- Dean of Students Office – Emergency support and student advocacy: 828-227-7234

Note: This syllabus is subject to change. The instructor reserves the right to modify the course schedule, assignments, and policies. Changes will be announced promptly via the LMS.